

UPDATED: March 8th, 2026



‘WE WILL REBUILD THIS
CATHEDRAL TOGETHER’ THE
BURNING OF THE NOTRE-DAME 2019
BACKGROUND GUIDE

TRITONMUN XXXI – APRIL 12TH, 2026
MODEL UNITED NATIONS AT UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, SAN DIEGO

BACKGROUND GUIDE TABLE OF CONTENTS

Head Chair Letter.....	2
Vice Chair Letter.....	3
Position Paper Guidelines.....	4
Rules of Procedure.....	5
DEI and AI policies.....	6
Key Terms.....	9
Introduction.....	10
Historical Background.....	12
Current Events.....	15
Case Study.....	18
Closing Remarks.....	21
Questions to Consider.....	22
Works Cited and Used Throughout.....	23
Characters List.....	26

HEAD CHAIR LETTER

Dear Delegates,

Welcome to TritonMUN XXXI, and especially welcome to ‘We Will Build This Cathedral Together’ The Burning of the Notre-Dame 2019! My name is Bethan Walters and I am delighted to be your Head Chair. I am a study-abroad student here at UCSD for the year, and I am from Wales in the United Kingdom. This is my third year of college, and I am a dual major in History and Political Science. This is my third year doing Model United Nations, and I have held many roles such as backrooming, vice-chairing, chairing, and executive positions! Beyond MUN, I am an avid baker, board game player, and lover of musicals. These hobbies certainly take up a lot of my time, but in my experience, it has been incredibly rewarding.

This is my first time running a committee of my choice, so I am eager to see what direction you all head with this topic. I am incredibly excited to run this committee, as the topic provides intersectionality between political, cultural, religious, and overall practical solutions to an event that has been deemed a ‘predictable surprise’. Whilst the actual impact may on the surface seem like a building simply burnt down, it had many implications beyond this within France, and diplomatically. Delegates should take into consideration the multidimensional nature of this committee, consider past actions taken with disaster management, and also be prepared to offer creative and fun solutions. I am ready to expect the unexpected, and you never know, there may just be an element or two that surprises you...

I wish you all the best of luck, and most importantly to have fun!

Kind regards,

Bethan Walters

bewalters@ucsd.edu

VICE CHAIR LETTER

Greetings Delegates,

I would first like to welcome all of you to ‘We Will Build This Cathedral Together’ The Burning of the Notre-Dame 2019, and TritonMUN XXXI. My name is Fuma Takahashi, and I am excited to Vice Chair for this committee. At UC San Diego, I currently major in Structural Engineering with a specialization on civil structures, coincidentally relating to this topic. I have been involved in MUN since high school, with this year marking my fourth. When not occupied with committee sessions, or work, I enjoy photography, exploring, and making myself some good food. Having these peaceful times to relax makes me very well rested and prepares me for the busyness that awaits.

This committee is unique in a way that explores the complex nature of this significant event that occurred in the past, potentially requiring rapid responses to a changing environment as if we just received the news about this disaster. The topic also allows every delegate to hold a creative and original perspective on this situation, which I am very much looking forward to during this debate. Regardless of how you approach this topic, it would be great to hear professional yet enjoyable insights from every one of the delegates in the room.

Wishing everyone the best, and hopefully a good amount of rest before the conference!

Respectfully,

Fuma Takahashi

ftakahashi@ucsd.edu

POSITION PAPER GUIDELINES

TRITONMUN POSITION PAPER GUIDELINES

- Position Papers are due on **April 3rd at 11:59pm.**
 - Requests for extensions must be sent by the advisor to TritonMUN by **March 22nd.**
- Position Papers must be submitted to the **Google Form** linked here:
 - <https://forms.gle/JCJmEeA6TGm8zjot6>
- Format.
 - Papers should be double-spaced in Times New Roman 12 pt. font and include no pictures.
 - At the top of each paper, include your country/person, name, committee, and topic.
 - Required* Sections: Each of these sections should be clearly labeled
 - Background
 - Past Actions by the Committee (if applicable)
 - Position of your Country/Person
 - Possible Solutions

*Some committees may ask for different formatting or an alternative to a position paper altogether, this will be clearly noted in the background guide for that committee

RULES OF PROCEDURE

The committee 'We Will Rebuild This Cathedral Together' The Burning of the Notre-Dame 2019 is a specialised committee in nature, and the rules of procedure for this committee will be as follows:

The committee will primarily run on GA rules of procedure, which means that delegates will be working towards over the course of the day a resolution style of document. Due to the delegates discussing only one 'topic' area, there will not be a section for topic choosing. Delegates will be participating in moderated and unmoderated discussions, before voting for the plan that they endorse most. **HOWEVER...**

What makes this committee specialised in nature (other than being characters, instead of countries) is that there will be two 'updates' throughout the committee, one in the beginning which will mirror the beginning scenario you will be presented with, which is in this document. This first update will also include a surprise element which is not mentioned in this document, but will be relevant to include. The second update will be at the conclusion of the committee, which will take into account what actions have been taken throughout the committee and the final document(s) that have been passed or failed.

Finally, at some point throughout the committee there will be a timed crisis. This will be kept as a surprise element, and one in which will help decide how the final update will be given out. Delegates in this timed crisis will not be expected to write any directives, new documents, or any form of note. It will centre around the public aspect of this committee, and I am excited to see how you deal with this. In the interest of time, this element MAY get removed if the committee will require more time to complete the document.

DEI AND AI POLICIES

Sensitivity & Harassment Policy:

TritonMUN is committed to fostering a healthy environment for diplomacy and dialogue, and upholding standards of diversity, equity, and inclusion for all delegates. Harassment or disruptive behavior of any kind—whether verbal or non-verbal, in or out of committee—is strictly prohibited. All attendees and staffers should be treated with equal respect, and discrimination on the basis of race, color, gender identity, sexual orientation, religion, nationality, ethnicity, or physical/mental disability will not be tolerated. This list is not exhaustive, and should not be treated as such. **Please report any instances of harassment to conference staff, either directly or through the Anonymous Feedback Form.**

In addition, we acknowledge that topics discussed in-committee may be politically sensitive, particularly in Specialized and Crisis Committees. While we understand that delegates may be immersed in the action and setting of their committee, delegates must maintain decorum and refrain from inflammatory language and actions, even when doing so may be historically accurate to one's character, group, or country. When drafting crisis directives, delegates should refrain from pursuing any action that explicitly violates human rights, including—but not limited to—enslavement and genocide. **Please refer to your committee's background guide for specific sensitivity statements and guidelines, and direct any questions to the committee's head chair.**

All attendants should observe these policies during the entirety of the conference, even outside formal debate, including opening/closing ceremonies, “FUNMUN”, etc. Please note that violation of these policies may result in consequences such as disqualification from awards and contact towards the delegate's Advisor. At TritonMUN, our goal has always been focused on the delegate's abilities to enjoy and have fun in committee. However, in order to truly enjoy TritonMUN, delegates must feel safe in committee, which starts with respecting one another.

In the context of the committee ‘We Will Rebuild This Cathedral Together’ The Burning of the Notre-Dame 2019, this sensitivity statement is upheld, and will be clarified considering some of the sensitive nature of this committee. As a committee which has a religious undertone, it is

imperative that delegates remain respectful at all times regarding religion. This includes ensuring no disrespectful language, jokes, or comments will be tolerated about any religion, and ensuring respect surrounding an individual's choice to be practicing or non-practicing religiously.

In addition to this, delegates will be assigned real individuals who were facing this calamity in 2019, but this does not mean that all aspects of the individual are relevant. Delegates are reminded that the focus of this committee is to address the disaster and provide a plan, not to focus on the past actions of the individual characters. Whilst relevant discourse and criticism of individuals is an integral part of accountability, it is not something that this committee aims to focus upon. Any discussion or mention of aspects of any character that is not relevant to the advancement of this committee will not be entertained.

Finally, despite this committee being situated in France and having French characters, delegates are reminded that the committee discussion and work should be completed entirely in English. Talking, writing, or producing any work in another language is an equity issue, and will not be tolerated. Additionally, this also extends to accents. It is entirely inappropriate at any stage to mimic any accent that is not authentically your own.

If there are any further questions, comments, or concerns then please feel free to contact the dias at the following email address: bewalters@ucsd.edu

Plagiarism & Generative AI Policy:

TritonMUN recognizes that Model United Nations provides a space for aspiring leaders to showcase their work and abilities, and that all delegates wish to be evaluated in a fair and accurate manner. As such, we expect all delegates to perform with integrity and refrain from plagiarizing the work of their peers. This includes—but is not limited to—claiming the work of another delegate as one's own, including another bloc's unique clause without prior approval from the original writer, and replacing another's work with one's own (i.e. overwriting).

In addition, delegates are strictly prohibited from utilizing generative AI to produce position papers, resolutions, and directives, in part or in their entirety.

Resolution Work Outside of Committee:

TritonMUN wishes that all delegates use their breaks and downtime as intended: to connect, relax, and refresh. While not in committee, delegates are strictly prohibited from working on resolutions and directives. In addition, this means that pre-writing, or preparing resolutions and directives before the start of the conference, is strictly prohibited.

Technology Policy:

Delegates should expect the use of technology to be limited during committee sessions. Instead of having a universal technology policy for TritonMUN, such policies are individualized for each committee and set by their daises. Please refer to each committee's background guide to understand their technology policies, and direct any questions to the committee's head chair. Repercussive actions will be taken at the discretion of the head chair.

Due to this committee being Specialised in nature, which follows mostly GA procedure, the technology policy for this committee is as follows: Technology shall only be permitted during unmoderated caucuses for the purpose of resolution writing. No technology shall be permitted during moderated debate, voting bloc, or during any specialised procedure that arises. Failure to comply with this policy will lead to consequences from an informal warning, up to ineligibility for awards depending on the severity and how many times requested for technology to be placed away. Additionally, any logistical issues surrounding access to the internet, technology not working, or accessibility should be brought to the attention of the Head Chair. Assistance can be provided and reasonable adjustments will be made and accommodated.

KEY TERMS

Christendom - The society or worldwide body of Christians.

Relics of the Passion of Christ - Relics that are associated with the crucifixion of Christ, in this committee these are the Crown of Thorns, a nail and fragments of wood from the cross used in the crucifixion.

Religious Centre/'Centre' - A space or location that has religious significance for worship, prayer, and community gathering.

Diocese - A district that is under the territorial jurisdiction of a Bishop.

Spire - An ornamental tip of a tower, this is described as a tapering structure and is commonly found on churches and cathedrals.

Choir/Quire - A space for clergy members and the church choir to sit

Baroque style - A cultural movement in the 1600s, which highlights elaborate details such as carvings, having a great deal of contrast between light and shadow, and emphasises movement.

Gothic architecture - An architectural style which was prominent in Europe between 1100-1500. It has prominent features such as pointed arches and incredibly tall buildings.

Grandeur - A quality or state of something being grand, magnificent, or impressive.

Vault - An architectural feature which helps to support the ceiling or roof of a building.

A human chain/'Bucket Brigade' - A method used to transport items from one place to another using individuals who are stationary, and passing it to one another. This was used in the form of passing buckets of water in the firefighting effort seen.

Short circuit - An electrical mechanism which allows for electric current to flow through an unintended path with low resistance, where the resistance is usually much greater. This can cause fires to begin.

‘WE WILL REBUILD THIS CATHEDRAL TOGETHER’ THE BURNING OF THE NOTRE DAME 2019

INTRODUCTION

This committee is based upon the real life event of the Burning of the Notre-Dame on the 15th of April 2019, in which the committee shall take place on the 16th of April 2019 at 9am. This means that the delegates will not be focusing on how to put out the fire, but rather dealing with the aftermath. The exact scenario is at the end of this introduction, but delegates will be asked to consider how to rebuild the cathedral, discuss financial options in order to fund this, and navigate the press surrounding the event.

Delegates are welcome to research how this was resolved by the actors involved, and the timeline they used. Nevertheless, it is important to note that it is not required or expected that the delegates will imitate the actual plan. Delegates are encouraged to recognise what went well, but to learn from the miscalculations made by those who decided how to resolve the situation. Additionally, delegates by design have been given characters that will have different priorities, considerations, and visions for how the Cathedral shall be rebuilt. Whilst you may be given a character whose job is financial, religious, cultural, or spiritual, it is essential to consider all of these aspects in tandem.

As aforementioned, this committee will run primarily on GA style ROP, and so the requested document at the end shall be a resolution document. This should reassure you that complicated architectural plans are not required, but simply an outline of how you are considering certain elements is what is expected. Finally, whilst this committee is certainly more serious in nature than a few others in this conference, it is okay to add some silly and fun elements. The chair smiles upon this, and encourages you to add in these aspects. An example could be that you will organise mass bake sales to raise money for this, which is a valid form of fundraising in collaboration with others. The one warning I will give on the silly measures is to ensure it is not at the expense of religion, or will be seen as making a mockery of the event itself. Otherwise

delegates, the world is your oyster! Now that these advisory messages have been given to you, let us move onto the scenario you will be faced with:

On the 15th of April 2019 at around 6:18pm CEST, a fire broke out in the attic of the Notre-Dame de Paris. This fire was not seen until half an hour later due to confusion amongst the staff, and by that point had spread catastrophically. Firefighters arrived at the scene by 7pm, and continued their efforts in saving the Notre-Dame de Paris until the morning of the 16th of April. Shockwaves were sent around the world at this event, as numerous questions began to rise. How did this happen? How is this going to affect the Catholic community? Has an important piece of French history been lost? What happens next? How is the French President going to respond?

Emmanuel Macron, who is the French President, has brought all of you here together sharply at 9am on the 16th of April as an emergency advisory committee. It is composed of politicians, firefighters, bishops, charity board members, and restoration workers. Your job is simple: to create a plan on how to rebuild the Notre-Dame de Paris, reassure the public, and gather relevant funding in order to do this. Emmanuel Macron will be presenting this plan by the end of the committee, and an update at the end will convey what happened and where we are in the present. In order for you to complete this task set, it is necessary that you understand the historical background that precedes this event.

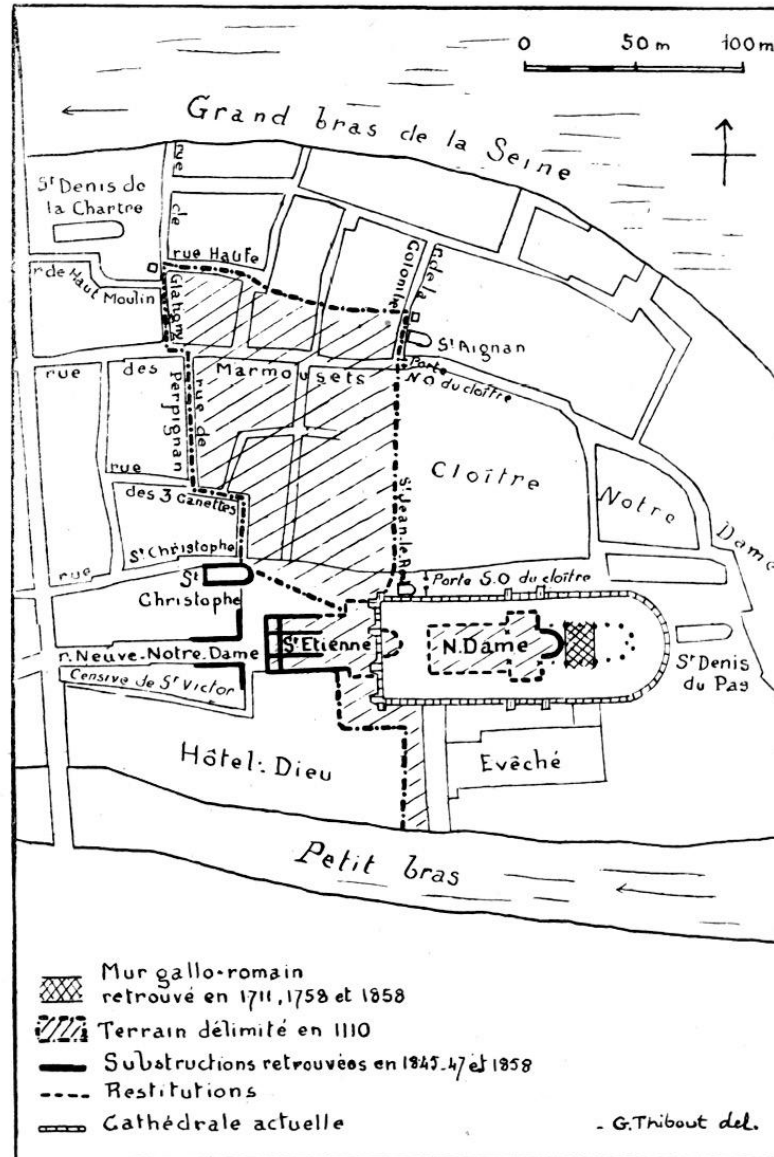
HISTORICAL BACKGROUND

The Kingdom of the Franks (which was a precursor to France) traditionally followed a Pagan tradition, until in the fourth century AD, when King Clovis, who was King of the Franks and was the religious and political founder of the Kingdom, converted the Kingdom to Christianity. This began the era of Paris becoming a Christian centre, and solidifying the city as a place for the Christian faith in Europe.

With this development and growth of population, a need for a place of worship grew in order to have a community. This led to the creation of the first cathedral in Paris, Saint-Étienne. The Cathedral of Saint-Étienne was built on the Île de la Cité (Island at the heart of Paris) and was a precursor to the construction of the Notre-Dame. The Île de la Cité was not only important due to the establishment of Saint-Étienne, but it was also a political centre of French politics. The Palais de la Cité was where kings resided for many years. This location was pivotal, and the establishment of the cathedral was a success.

Over the next few centuries, the Diocese of Paris had flourished especially under Saint Marcel and Saint Germain. However, the Cathedral of Saint-Étienne was no longer able to support this growth, and there became an increasing need to upsize in relation to the grandeur that Paris was now receiving, especially with the prominence of the Virgin Mary that Parisians focused upon. It was in the twelfth century when Bishop Maurice de Sully, who had witnessed the Basilica of Saint-Denis and the ever-growing influence of Gothic architecture, envisioned something bigger: Notre-Dame de Paris. In 1163, the first stone was laid for this project, with Pope Alexander III gracing the ceremony. This was the beginning of a journey, as it was not until two centuries later that the building of the Notre-Dame de Paris was completed and remained important. The building of the Notre-Dame Cathedral occurred on the original site of Saint-Étienne Cathedral, and so the original foot traffic for the Cathedral was included in the opening of the brand new place of worship.

The picture below showcases the location of the built Notre-Dame, with its location and whereabouts with important aspects surrounding it.



By the 17th century, Notre-Dame and France gained prestige when Louis XIV dedicated France to the Virgin Mary. Due to the name of the Cathedral translating to 'Our Lady of Paris' this was a monumental step, as it showcased the Notre-Dame Cathedral and Paris as fundamental to the

country as a whole. This gained prestige meant that renovations became necessary on the Notre-Dame to model it after the increasingly popular Baroque style, so that it remained as a pivotal landmark and place of worship. Under architect Robert de Cotte, the choir was redesigned, and medieval elements were removed such as the stained glass windows. This was to reflect the taste and move into contemporary elements, which was a large theme at the time considering the arrival of the French Revolution.

The French Revolution occurred due to public unease over the display of aristocratic and royal grandeur at the Notre-Dame, as it coincided with a time when the French people were starving. In 1793, the Notre-Dame Cathedral was ransacked, which left many of the treasures found within the Cathedral destroyed. In addition to the Notre-Dame de Paris being ransacked, the banning of Catholicism occurred. As the Notre-Dame could no longer serve its purpose as a place for Catholic worship, it was repurposed as a ‘Temple of Reason’ and a wine warehouse. This repurposing of the Notre-Dame continued up until the nineteenth century, where the prior grandeur that it had was entirely lost.

The revival of the Notre-Dame occurred in an unconventional way, as it was the creation of the novel ‘Notre-Dame de Paris’ (The English title: The Hunchback of the Notre-Dame) by Victor Hugo. Hugo’s admiration for the Notre-Dame led to this novel being completed in 1831, and just thirteen years later, the architect Eugène Viollet-le-Duc started a twenty-five-year restoration project. This restoration project restored some of the Gothic elements, especially the wooden spire that was added. This was the same spire that burnt down in 2019. This brought back the grandeur that the Notre-Dame de Paris once had, and led to UNESCO declaring it a World Heritage Site a century later in 1991.

CURRENT EVENTS

On the 15th April 2019, at around 18:20pm a fire alarm was triggered and led to the evacuation of the Cathedral and a guard was sent to investigate. There was a considerable amount of confusion from the staff, which led to the guard checking the adjacent sacristy instead of the actual attic in the Notre-Dame (La Forêt). It wasn't until half an hour later that the mistake was discovered, and once the correct location was searched, the fire had already spread through the wooden lattice structure that was holding up the Cathedral's lead roof.

Despite the initial confusion surrounding the location of the fire, firefighters emerged at the scene by 19:00pm CEST. When the firefighters began to climb the three hundred steps up to the attic, they were pushed back by the fire and were unable to save the attic due to the safety concerns for the firefighters. There was a large firefighting force of approximately five hundred, and leading the tactical effort was the Deputy Commander of the Paris Fire Brigade who was able to direct their efforts towards an important consideration: minimising damage.

In order to ensure the entirety of the Notre-Dame was not burnt down, the firefighting efforts were directed at the Cathedral's towers. There was a great deal of fear that if the Northern tower (which had already caught on fire) was not extinguished, it would lead to the collapse of eight bells which in turn would have destroyed the rest of the Cathedral. Fortunately, utilising methods such as the 'Bucket Brigade' human chain, they were able to avoid the worst-case scenario and localise the damage of the fire to the attic and roof. By 21:45 that evening, most of the fire had been extinguished, and by the early hours on the 16th of April, the fire was fully extinguished which put an end to the ordeal.



There were no reported casualties, injuries, or deaths, and some of the Cathedral's iconic features such as the famed rose windows remained intact. However, by 10am on the 16th of April, the world had changed.

When trying to assess as to exactly what had gone wrong, and why the fire was able to spread as far as it had, there was an initial investigation made. There were several factors which led to the intensity of the fire increasing, the first of which was the lack of sprinklers in the Notre-Dame's ceiling. This meant that when the fire had been detected, the only option to stop the fire was to rely on the 'Bucket Brigade/Human Chain' method of firefighting, which certainly slowed down the effort. Additionally, the Cathedral in the year 2018 had treated an issue with the timber in the cathedral with highly flammable antifungal spray, which led to the fire being able to spread much faster than had alternatives been pursued.

Finally, logistical issues when putting out the fire had a large impact on the extent in which the damage was spread. The water pressure from the fire hoses was poor and could not appropriately

deal with the flame. The firefighters themselves due to the issue of narrow passages in the ancient Cathedral, so they were not able to have the range of movement required to act with urgency, and simply kept bumping into each other. These issues showcased the biggest issue surrounding this event, the Notre-Dame de Paris was not well-equipped with fire prevention, but rather a harsh lesson was learnt that prevention was not a priority, and that disaster management became a necessity.

The population of France is mourning the damage to an important landmark, and there has been a media frenzy as people noticed the calamity in mere minutes. As the disaster was unfolding, people began to flock to the scene to witness the firefighters at work and to see what the conclusion would be. Many leaders of different countries, religious leaders, and individuals are all expressing messages of sympathy. However, there is a distinct undertone of confusion, as there is no clear answer yet as to how this happened. Was this purposeful? Did something go wrong with the electrical works within the Cathedral? These are all questions that have not been made clear yet with the information given by the time the committee is meeting.

All eyes are on the advisory body to act. What will you do?



CASE STUDY - THE RESTORATION OF ST PAUL'S CATHEDRAL IN LONDON

The Burning of the Notre-Dame de Paris was a unique event which had unique circumstances. However, this is not the first time in history in which an important building faced unexpected damage. After the events of the Blitz in London during WWII, St Paul's Cathedral in London suffered two direct bomb hits over the course of many months, as well as many other dangers. The direct bomb hits had lifted the quire roof from the Cathedral, which caused the masonry to fall and this destroyed the altar below it. As well as the second bomb hit in 1941, rocking the dome, exposing the crypt below the floor, and the pushing of the south wall of the South transept which broke every window.

St Paul's has a similar level of history and prestige as the Notre-Dame de Paris, and once the environment was safe again, there was discourse around how to restore the Cathedral to its former glory and ensure continued tourism to London. As the bombs that had hit St Paul's Cathedral presented a fire risk, teams of volunteers worked hard over the course of months to ensure there were no fire risks for the sake of the building, any damage that was inflicted onto the Cathedral was restored by architects, and that there was little danger to surrounding buildings and locals, there was a decision made. Three of those who had assisted and risked their lives during these events were presented with the George Cross for their effort and bravery, whilst others were taken out by the locals for a drink as a thank you.

Alongside recognising the courage and bravery of those involved, there were decisions made on what to do next regarding the restoration process. Below is a document highlighting a portion of the process. A Letter to Dean Walter Matthews, from members of the St Paul's Watch, 11 October 1942, to mark their contribution towards the replacement of the keystone to the arch over the High Altar (Ref. No. SPCAA/SPW/3/6/3).

SPCAA/SPW/3/6/1

September 1942. 14 NORTH AUDLEY STREET
GROSVENOR SQUARE, W.1.

(Private & Confidential.)

Dear *Wakelam*

The new KEYSTONE of the arch over the High Altar, replacing that shattered by enemy bomb on October the 10th. 1940, is now lying in its rough state on the floor of the Chancel ready for hoisting into position.

It carries some fifty cubic feet of finest Portland stone & will most surely look down at the faithful for many centuries to come.

Would it not be an inspiring idea for the Builders, Surveyors & Architects (whose very existence is bound up in building) who, for many Months and Years, *laeti laborum*, have formed a no inconsiderable part of St. Paul's Watch, to present the key-stone to the Dean and Chapter as a memorial of the service they have been privileged to render to the Cathedral?

Fifty Pounds would approximately cover the cost, so I write to inquire if you would care to take your share in such a gift.

If each of us:

"we few, we happy few, we band of brothers",

were to contribute thirty shillings, there would be no difficulty in raising the sum required.

Members of the Watch who have been scolded are well pleased with the idea and I am hopeful that the response will be unanimous. If you are willing to subscribe, perhaps you will be kind enough to send me a cheque.

Alternatively, it would fit the scheme just as well, if you preferred to allocate to this end the subsistence payments we receive, until your 30/- has been paid up. I enclose a Form for you to sign and return to me.

Sincerely Yours,
Arthur Paget-arran

Those who were discussing this case as showcased above discussed the appropriate material, and justifying the cost due to 'it looking down on the faithful for many centuries to come'. The request of donations in order to complete this project was an integral part of this project, as the materials needed to ensure that St Paul's Cathedral would need to be sturdy, appropriate, and able to withstand any future calamities if they arose. Funding was not only given from generous donations from the public, but also from other funding such as the War Damage Commission.

Key elements such as the vaulting, carvings, mosaics, and full repair of the North Transept were completed over time, with the assistance of individuals who understood the cultural, historical, and material considerations. Those who made the decisions focused their efforts to ensure that the restoration was replicating the work that had previously been there, whilst working with considerable constraints due to the country being actively in war and then recovering from that war economically and emotionally.

Most of the major restoration work was completed by 1946, just a few years after the two direct bomb hits which caused that level of damage. In 1948, the King and Queen of the United Kingdom were able to host their Silver Anniversary Service in the Cathedral. Upholding the tradition behind it, and showcasing that whilst the Cathedral may not have been fully restored, some normality could arise during this time. The full restoration of St Paul's Cathedral was completed in 1962, and to this day stands strong in the Heart of London. It continues to serve the religious community, bolster tourism which encourages individuals to learn the history and culture behind the piece, and is an iconic piece of English history.

This case study showcases despite this disaster occurring many decades prior, it has many similarities and things to consider when implementing the plan. Will you mimic this plan with rewarding the efforts of those who were brave, seek fundraising methods, look into appropriate materials and designs, and have a timeframe to complete the work in? It is wise to look into this case study for both inspiration and ways to improve, as well as considering modern elements such as the rise of technology and social media. The damage to St Paul's Cathedral was on a smaller scale, so ensuring appropriate effort, funds, and timing is given will be crucial to answering this.

CLOSING REMARKS

To give some concluding remarks, the Burning of the Notre-Dame de Paris is a calamity which has an incredible amount of historical consequences. It was the continuation of the Saint-Étienne Cathedral which is where the emergence of Christianity happened in Paris, went through remarkable renovations and progress to take into consideration the dominant architectural style, saw a kingdom fall and political revolutions emerge, and has remained relevant for many centuries. Now that a large section of the Cathedral has burnt down, and there is significant discourse online expressing sympathy and concern, this is where you step in. Delegates should use the information considered in order to understand the severity, consider the case study as an example of how restoration can work, and find ways in which working together can bring about a positive result.

There are many routes that can be taken, and there is a lot more research that can be utilised for any aspect of this issue. I encourage you to go beyond this guide, as even though it has everything that is necessary to participate in this committee, there is a great deal of literature that will always help you on this journey. However, it is important to consider your role as characters, and demonstrate your unique angles and perspectives on life. Incorporating this into your work will only help you, not hinder you.

Lastly, the last concluding message is to have fun. This committee has many relevant discussions, but has a lot of opportunity to enjoy the decisions you make whilst remaining respectful. We will certainly be rebuilding this Cathedral together, and we cannot wait to see what happens next.

Until we see you soon delegates!

‘We Will Rebuild This Cathedral Together’ The Burning of the Notre-Dame 2019 staffing dais.

QUESTIONS TO CONSIDER

1. **What should the restoration efforts look like?** How can the historical, cultural, and religious elements previously installed be remade?
 2. **What design process should be used?** What architectural elements should be included? Should it be designed in a similar way as before, or should it include more resistant materials?
 3. **How long should it take to complete the restoration plan?** What timeframe should be offered?
 4. **Should an alternative place of worship be offered in the meantime?** How will this work?
 5. **What is the best approach to addressing the public?** How does a lack of information impact the ability to explain the event?
 6. **What economic ramifications will this event have?** How will tourism be impacted? How will this project be funded?
 7. **How does international relations play into this event?** How has the perception of France impacted diplomatic measures?
 8. **What caused the fire?** Should an investigation be set in place to figure out the cause of the fire?
 9. **How can a tragic event such as this be avoided in the future?** Should relevant disaster prevention plans be discussed within this?
-

WORKS CITED/USED THROUGHOUT

Biographs.org. (2017a). *Agnes Buzyn biography. French hematologist, immunologist and transplantologist*. [online] Available at: <https://biographs.org/agnes-buzyn>

Biographs.org. (2017b). *Edouard Philippe biography. French politician, member of parliament*. [online] Available at: https://biographs.org/edouard-philippe#google_vignette

Blakemore, E. (2019). *The Notre Dame Cathedral Was Nearly Destroyed By French Revolutionary Mobs | HISTORY*. [online] HISTORY. Available at: <https://www.history.com/articles/notre-dame-fire-french-revolution>.

Carla Knorowski. (2020). *Carla Knorowski*. [online] Available at: <https://www.carlaknorowski.com>

Chapelle, P.F. (2024). *Portrait Ministériel - DENORMANDIE, Julien - SAPERE*. [online] SAPERE. Available at: <https://sapere.page/denormandie-julien/>

Cheney, D.M. (1951). *Archbishop Michel Christian Alain Aupetit [Catholic-Hierarchy]*. [online] Catholic-hierarchy.org. Available at: <https://catholic-hierarchy.org/bishop/baupetit.html>

Cook, L. (2019). *Leaving a Trace | Vassar College*. [online] Vassar.edu. Available at: <https://www.vassar.edu/news/leaving-a-trace>.

Emmanuel-gregoire-2026.fr. (2026). *Emmanuel Grégoire pour Paris*. [online] Available at: <https://emmanuel-gregoire-2026.fr/#idees>

Forbes. (2024). *Anne Hidalgo*. [online] Available at: <https://www.forbes.com/profile/anne-hidalgo/>.

Friends of Notre-Dame de Paris (2022). *Notre-Dame Cathedral Fire | Before & After the Fire*. [online] Friends of Notre-Dame de Paris. Available at: <https://www.friendsofnotredamedeparis.org/notre-dame-cathedral/fire/>.

Friends of Notre-Dame de Paris. (2016). *Leadership | Friends of Notre-Dame de Paris*. [online] Available at: <https://www.friendsofnotredamedeparis.org/about/leadership/>

Gallet, G.J.-C. (2024). *Leadership under fire: Inside the decision-making that saved Notre-Dame - I by IMD*. [online] IMD business school for management and leadership courses. Available at: <https://www.imd.org/ibyimd/leadership/leadership-under-fire-inside-the-decision-making-that-saved-notre-dame/>

historicengland.org.uk. (n.d.). *St Paul's Cathedral (Blitz Stories) | Historic England*. [online] Available at: <https://historicengland.org.uk/whats-new/features/blitz-stories/st-paul-s-cathedral/>.

<https://paris-notredame.com/>. (2026). *The Remarkable History of Notre Dame Cathedral in Paris*. [online] Available at: <https://paris-notredame.com/plan-your-visit/history/>.

info.gouv.fr. (2025). *Ministère de l'Aménagement du territoire et de la Décentralisation | info.gouv.fr*. [online] Available at: <https://www.info.gouv.fr/ministere/ministere-de-lamenagement-du-territoire-et-de-la-decentralisation>

La compagnie des Architectes en Chef des Monuments Historiques. (2025). *Prunet Pascal - La compagnie des Architectes en Chef des Monuments Historiques*. [online] Available at: <https://www.compagnie-acmh.fr/architectes/prunet-pascal/>

Leaders Wiki. (2024). *Franck Riester: A Dynamic Force in French Politics and Culture - Leaders Wiki*. [online] Available at: <https://leaders-wiki.com/2024/09/franck-riester-a-dynamic-force-in-french-politics-and-culture/>

Manpowergroup.com. (2023). *Muriel Pénicaud*. [online] Available at: <https://www.manpowergroup.com/en/about/leadership/muriel-penicaud>

McKirdy, E., Vandoorne, S. and Fox, K. (2019). *Notre Dame probe ramps up as investigators question workers*. [online] CNN. Available at: <https://edition.cnn.com/2019/04/17/europe/notre-dame-fire-investigation-intl/index.html>

Mitchell, K. (2019). Clovis I | Biography, Significance, & Facts. In: *Encyclopædia Britannica*. [online] Available at: <https://www.britannica.com/biography/Clovis-I>.

New York Encounter. (2026). *New York Encounter*. [online] Available at: <https://www.newyorkencounter.org/philippe-villeneuve>

Noe, R. (2023). *An Architecture Student's Project Made Notre Dame's Restoration Possible - Core77*. [online] Core77. Available at: <https://www.core77.com/posts/123862/An-Architecture-Students-Project-Made-Notre-Dames-Restoration-Possible>.

Notre-Dame fire lead pollution endangered life, lawsuit claims. (2021). *BBC News*. [online] 6 Jul. Available at: <https://www.bbc.com/news/world-europe-57733690>.

Pentin, E. (2019). *Notre Dame Priest: How Blessed Sacrament, Crown of Thorns Were Saved From Fire*. [online] NCR. Available at: <https://www.ncregister.com/blog/notre-dame-priest-how-blessed-sacrament-crown-of-thorns-were-saved-from-fire>

Reuters Staff (2024). Macron replaces embattled education minister with former justice minister Belloubet. *Reuters*. [online] 8 Feb. Available at: <https://www.reuters.com/world/europe/macron-replaces-embattled-education-minister-with-former-justice-minister-2024-02-08/>.

Roche, D.J. (2024). *Notre-Dame Cathedral reopens in Paris after renovation by Philippe Villeneuve, Rémi Fromont, Pascal Prunet, and many others*. [online] The Architect's Newspaper. Available at: <https://www.archpaper.com/2024/12/notre-dame-cathedral-reopens/>.

St Paul's Cathedral. (n.d.). *Wartime damage and repair*. [online] Available at: <https://www.stpauls.co.uk/wartime-damage-and-repair>.

Tutela Minorum. (2025). *Mons. Thibault Verny - Tutela Minorum*. [online] Available at: <https://www.tutelaminorum.va/the-commission/mons-thibault-verny/>

Vatican.va. (2019). *Message of the Holy Father to the Archbishop of Paris, France, for the fire in the Cathedral of Notre Dame (16 April 2019)*. [online] Available at: https://www.vatican.va/content/francesco/en/messages/pont-messages/2019/documents/papa-francesco_20190416_messaggio-incendio-notredame.html

www.friendsofnotredamedeparis.org. (2022). *The Origins of Notre-Dame Cathedral*. [online] Available at: <https://www.friendsofnotredamedeparis.org/notre-dame-cathedral/history/before-the-cathedral-was-built/>.

www.justice.gouv.fr. (2023). *Missions et organisation | Ministère de la justice*. [online] Available at: <https://www.justice.gouv.fr/ministere-justice/missions-organisation>.

CHARACTERS LIST

Édouard Philippe

Prime Minister of France

Édouard Philippe is a Politician who was appointed as the Prime Minister of France under Emmanuel Macron since May 15th 2017. His role includes duties such as being the nominal head of the French government, as well as overseeing the Council of Ministers. It is important to note that whilst being the nominal head of the French government, the Prime Minister does not chair the meetings, as this is a role presumed by the French President.

Bruno Le Maire

Minister of the Economy

Bruno Le Maire is a Politician who was appointed as the Minister of the Economy on May 17th 2017. His role includes authority over the financial assets of France, ensuring fiscal responsibility and accountability, as well as being the Representative for France in the Economic and Financial Affairs Council. Some duties include taxation and budgetary management.

Christophe Castaner

Minister of the Interior

Christophe Castaner is a Politician who was appointed as the Minister of the Interior on October 16th 2018. His role includes maintaining and ensuring cohesion for the country's institutions, throughout the entirety of the territories of France. Some of the duties include security and law enforcement, immigration, and generally public administration.

Jean-Yves Le Drian

Minister of Europe and Foreign Affairs

Jean-Yves Le Drian was appointed the Minister of Europe and Foreign Affairs on May 17th 2017. The duties of his role include handling the foreign relations of France. This includes promoting, defending, and promoting the interests of France abroad.

Franck Riester

Minister of Culture

Franck Riester was appointed the Minister of Culture on 16th October 2018. His role and duties include building reforms within the cultural considerations of France. This often includes working alongside the media and broadcasting agencies, advocating for the cultural heritage of France to be maintained, and saving various historical sites from demolition. His expertise and understanding of cultural aspects of the Notre-Dame ensures a good mix of political and cultural considerations are met.

Julien Denormandie

Minister of Housing and Urban Renovation

Julien Denormandie is the Minister of Housing and Urban Renovation and was appointed to this role in October 2018. His duties within this role includes housing policy, issues surrounding building permits, and considering the impacts this will have on the public. Whilst his role is less relevant to the actual burning of the Cathedral, he has in the past dealt with territorial cohesion, addressing public concerns, and having an expertise generally within politics.

Agnès Buzyn

Minister of Health

Agnès Buzyn was appointed to the position of Minister of Health in the year 2017. Her past qualifications include working in healthcare as an expert hematologist/immunologist, working in various sectors such as medicine, public health, and politics. Her current duties as Minister of Health include concerns surrounding the healthcare sector, and for this particular committee understanding the impacts of the smoke inhalation, and lead contamination from the fire.

Muriel Pénicaud

Minister of Labour, Employment, and Economic Inclusion

Muriel Pénicaud is the Minister of Labour, Employment, and Economic Inclusion, and was appointed to this role in 2017. Her role focuses on legislation surrounding employment, labour, and integration of foreigners economically. Within this committee, concerns surrounding who

will complete the restoration work, those who work in the Cathedral who may be impacted by potential closure of the Cathedral, and issues surrounding the rights of those involved.

Nicole Belloubet

Minister of Justice

Nicole Belloubet is the Minister of Justice, whose past career trajectory is focused around the legal sector. She was appointed on 21st June 2017, and her role in government includes ensuring the process of the law is followed, the courts are functioning, and to be in charge of those who administer justice. Relevant considerations around how the fire began, and ensuring legal processes are followed if investigations were to occur is within Nicole Belloubet's realm of remit.

Jacqueline Gourault

Minister of Territorial Development

Jacqueline Gourault is the Minister of Territorial Development, as appointed by President Emmanuel Macron, as advised by the Prime Minister. The Minister of Territorial Development's role includes ensuring social cohesion between the various territories of France, promotion of attractiveness of these areas, and planning policies for the entire nation. With the fire devastating an iconic landmark which brought attraction to Paris, Jacqueline Gourault is a relevant presence.

Anne Hidalgo

Mayor of Paris

Anne Hidalgo is the Mayor of Paris and has been in office since 2014. As a member of a unique governing body specifically spearheaded by what Paris requires, this event has had a large impact for many areas. Her presence in the committee ensures the impact this event has for the past, present, and future of Paris is considered, and ensures a more regional political view of the issues at hand.

Emmanuel Grégoir

Deputy Mayor of Paris

Emmanuel Grégoir is the Deputy Mayor of Paris, and thus is the second-in-command for the regional body. Working closely with Anne Hidalgo and other members of the council represent multiple arrondissements to ensure what is best for the City of Paris is pursued. Additionally, Emmanuel Grégoir has a great deal of focus and experience with environmental and ecological concerns, which may provide an interesting lens for the committee.

Bruno Julliard

Councillor of Paris

Bruno Julliard is a member of the Council of Paris and represents the interests of the council as a whole. Having a greater deal of connection with fellow Parisians, and being at a much more ground level, he is able to bring a unique perspective to the thoughts, feelings, and concerns of the people. Additionally, his role includes relevant political, economic, and social considerations.

General Jean-Claude Gallet

Commander of the Paris Fire Brigade

General Jean-Claude Gallet is the Commander of the Paris Fire Brigade, and led the effort to extinguish the fire. He has years of military and firefighting operational experience, and ensured that he retained strategic control whilst passing tactical control onto his Deputy Commander Phillipe Demay. His duty included managing the safety of his force, communicating with those in charge, and now representing the force, his decision-making that day, and discussions around further disaster management.

Phillipe Demay

Deputy Commander of the Paris Fire Brigade

Phillipe Demay is the Deputy Commander of the Paris Fire Brigade, who is the second-in-command for the firefighting effort. Phillipe Demay was present and participated in the fire-fighting effort, and had described the fire itself as ‘complex’ and that there were repeated concerns for the structural integrity of the Cathedral. His role in this committee is to represent

those who fought the fire, and address the relevant concerns around what happened and where to go next with fire-resistant materials.

Michel Aupetit

Archbishop of Paris

Michel Aupetit is the Archbishop of Paris and has held the position since 2017. He is responsible for the Diocese of Paris, and for keeping communication with the Vatican City and the Pope. In the event of this fire, his role will concern itself with addressing the public, evaluating the next steps, ensuring appropriate alternatives are sought, and ensuring the restoration effort is appropriate. He has been a member of the Catholic Church for many years, and has a great deal of expertise in this area.

Thibault Verny

Auxiliary Bishop of Paris

Thibault Verny is the Auxiliary Bishop of Paris and has been in that position since 2016. Prior to being established as the Auxiliary Bishop of Paris, he had a background in engineering and physics, before acquiring his licentiate in theology and becoming ordained as a Priest. His role in this advisory board concerns itself with the religious aspect of this crisis, and the interest of the Catholic public.

Father Jean-Marc Fournier

Chaplain to the Paris Fire Brigade

Father Jean-Marc Fournier is the Chaplain to the Paris Fire Brigade, and was present at the scene of the fire. He is widely seen as one of the main reasons as to why the Passions of the Relics of Christ were saved during the fire, and collaborated with the French President Emmanuel Macron and firefighters to ensure this happened. His role has an interesting intersection with the firefighting effort and religious elements.

Philippe Villeneuve

Architect-In-Chief of Historic Monuments

Philippe Villeneuve is the Architect-In-Chief of Historic Monuments, and has dedicated his entire career to ensure heritage preservation is maintained. His role includes ensuring that the aspects of the Notre-Dame that are significant are reimagined in this restoration, and seeking the best possible solutions and possible technological considerations. He has many impressive restoration projects, and has gained much recognition for this.

Rémi Fromont

Restoration Architect

Rémi Fromont is the second of the three notable Restoration Architects who have been brought onto this advisory board. His role includes ensuring that the historical and cultural aspects of the Cathedral are kept when rebuilding, and figuring out which materials are best to use. Only seven years prior to the events of the fire, Rémi Fromont was an architectural student who gained prestige quickly within the field, who studied medieval carvings and structures. He spent a year alongside a fellow student measuring the Notre-Dame de Paris' charpente (the timber-framed roof structure).

Pascal Prunet

Restoration Architect

Pascal Prunet is the final of the three notable Restoration Architects who are hired to complete the work of the restoration on the Notre-Dame de Paris. His role includes ensuring that the historical and cultural aspects of the Cathedral are kept when rebuilding, and figuring out which materials are best to use. Additionally, he has a great deal of experience in restoration of religious buildings with much of his work focusing on Cathedrals and Abbeys.

Michel Picaud

President of Friends of Notre-Dame de Paris

Michel Picaud is the President of Friends of Notre-Dame de Paris, which is a non-profit organisation focused around the restoration and revival of Notre-Dame. Duties include leading the fundraising for the effort, ensuring the importance of the Notre-Dame is distributed through their website, and working alongside Établissement Public. As the President, Michel Picaud's

role focuses around ensuring the organisation runs smoothly and being the most known face from the organisation. Michel Picaud in the past has also held roles such as COO and CEO of multiple organisations.

Jacques Puibaraud

Leadership Staff of Friends of Notre-Dame de Paris

Jacques Puibaraud is a member of the leadership staff of Friends of Notre-Dame de Paris, which is a non-profit organisation focused around the restoration and revival of Notre-Dame. Duties include leading the fundraising for the effort, ensuring the importance of the Notre-Dame is distributed through their website, and working alongside Établissement Public. As a member of the Leadership Staff, Jacques Puibaraud's role is more public facing and has an element of publicity around it. His unique role centres around 'special projects', in which this restoration aspect certainly fits.

Carla Knorowski

Board of Directors of Friends of Notre-Dame de Paris

Carla Knorowski is a member of the Board of Directors of Friends of Notre-Dame de Paris, which is a non-profit organisation focused around the restoration and revival of Notre-Dame. Duties include fundraising for the effort, ensuring the importance of the Notre-Dame is distributed through their website, and working alongside Établissement Public. Carla Knorowski additionally is an author, and a patron of volunteerism and philanthropy.